

Password Reset and Account Recovery Guide

1. Overview

This guide provides comprehensive instructions for recovering access to your account if you have forgotten your password, are locked out, or need to reset your credentials for security reasons. At [Company Name], we prioritize the security of your data and have implemented a secure, multi-step process to ensure that only authorized users can modify account settings.

2. Prerequisites

Before initiating a password reset, ensure you have the following:

- **Access to your registered email address:** You must be able to receive emails sent to the account associated with your profile.
- **Stable Internet Connection:** To avoid interrupted requests during the verification phase.
- **Authorized Device:** Ideally, use a browser or device you have previously used to log in, as this helps our security systems recognize your session.

3. Forgotten Password Recovery

If you cannot remember your password, follow these steps to regain access:

1. **Navigate to the Login Page:** Go to [\[https://app.yourcompany.com/login\]](https://app.yourcompany.com/login)(<https://app.yourcompany.com/login>).
2. **Initiate the Request:** Click the **"Forgot Password?"** link located directly beneath the password input field.
 - [Screenshot: Login screen with 'Forgot Password' link highlighted]
3. **Submit Your Email:** Enter the email address associated with your account and click **"Reset Password"**.
4. **Check Your Inbox:** Within a few minutes, you will receive an email from support@yourcompany.com with the subject line "Reset your [Company Name] password".
 - *Note: If you do not see the email in your primary inbox, please check your Spam/Junk folder.*

4. Email Verification and Reset Process

Once you receive the recovery email:

1. **Click the Secure Link:** Open the email and click the button labeled **"Reset My Password"**.
 - [Screenshot: Password reset email template with 'Reset My Password' button]
2. **Redirect to Reset Page:** Clicking the link will open a secure, time-sensitive page in your browser.

3. **Define Your New Password:** Enter your new password and confirm it in the second field.
4. **Save Changes:** Click "**Update Password**". You will be automatically redirected to the login page to sign in with your new credentials.

5. Security Best Practices: Password Strength

Your password is the first line of defense for your account. All passwords must adhere to our security policy:

- **Minimum Length:** 12 characters.
- **Complexity:** Must include at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character (e.g., !, @, #, \$).
- **Uniqueness:** Avoid using passwords you have used for other services.
- **Avoid Personal Info:** Do not use easily guessed information like names, birthdates, or common dictionary words.

6. Troubleshooting Common Issues

Expired Reset Links

For security reasons, password reset links expire after **15 minutes**. If you attempt to use an expired link, you will see an "Invalid or Expired Token" error.

- **Solution:** Return to the "Forgot Password" page and request a new reset email. Delete any older recovery emails to ensure you are using the most recent one.

Account Lockout Scenarios

After **five failed login attempts**, your account will be temporarily locked for **30 minutes** to prevent unauthorized access.

- **If you are locked out:** Please wait 30 minutes before attempting to log in again. If you continue to have trouble after the timer expires, use the "Forgot Password" flow to reset your credentials.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) Reset

If you have lost access to your MFA device (e.g., an authenticator app or security key) and cannot complete the login process:

1. Contact our **Support Team** at support@yourcompany.com.
2. You will be required to verify your identity through our manual verification process.
3. Once verified, we will disable MFA on your account, allowing you to log in with your password and re-configure MFA.

7. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

- **Q: Can I reuse an old password?**
 - A: No, our system maintains a history of your previous passwords for security. You must create a new, unique password.

- **Q: I never received the recovery email. What should I do?**
 - A: First, verify the email address you entered matches the one in our records. If the address is correct, please add support@yourcompany.com to your email "Safe Senders" list and try requesting the link again.
- **Q: Can I change my password from within my account?**
 - A: Yes. If you are already logged in, navigate to **Settings > Security > Change Password**. You will need to provide your current password to complete this update.
- **Q: Why does the system ask me to reset my password every 90 days?**
 - A: While not mandatory for all plans, we highly recommend rotating your passwords quarterly to minimize the risk associated with potential credential leakage.

8. Need Further Assistance?

If you are still unable to access your account after following the steps above, our support team is ready to assist. Please contact us via:

- **Email:** support@yourcompany.com
- **Live Chat:** Available 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM EST via the Help icon in your dashboard.
- **Support Portal:** <https://help.yourcompany.com>